Haskayne School of Business | Centre for Entrepreneurship and Innovation

# 2026 Digital Innovation Challenge Case Competition Finals Student Brief

*Sponsored by the Steve & Tina Wilson Family Foundation*

## COMPETITION BACKGROUND: FINAL ROUND

***Congratulations on advancing to the finals***! The Digital Innovation Challenge Case Competition 2026 culminates in an in-person showcase at the University of Calgary. This round will challenge your adaptability, critical thinking, and ability to refine your solution as you respond to a case twist. Finalist teams will be asked to bring their concepts to life by illustrating the student journey and demonstrating how their innovations address real-world needs in a meaningful and tangible way.

## OFFICIAL RULES FOR TEAMS

- All teams will prepare ***one case solution,*** according to the twist and the case provided.
- Only one case solution can be presented. ***Do not share*** alternative solutions.
- All teams will use Innovatank to submit their presentations.
- Your password in Innovatank will be the same as the preliminary round.
- Judging criteria will be provided with the case.
- ***The teams must submit their slides on Innovatank before the deadline on March 19, 2026, at 4:00pm (MST Canada). Late submissions of the deck will not be accepted.***
- All presentations are final, no alterations to presentations are allowed after the submission deadline.
- Presentations must be made in English and will be presented in person during the finals on March 20, 2026. **If you are unable to join us in-person, we will have the option for teams to present virtually. This will be done live on Zoom on March 20, 2026.**
- The solution must consist of:
    - A slide deck uploaded to Innovatank in PowerPoint format prior to the presentations.
    - Please ensure that you do **not** include any identifiable words, acronyms, logos, or references that reveal your school or city, either on the slides or while you are presenting. Any identifying information during the presentation may lead to team disqualification.
- Teams can use all resources available to them to research and develop their case solution. **Be diligent in using AI strategically but do not rely on it to think for you.**
- Each presentation will consist of a 15-minute presentation followed by 10 minutes of Q&A.
- The presenting team will be notified when five minutes and one-minute remains, both during their presentation and during the Q&A.
- Teams may only watch other teams present after they have already presented themselves. We will have breakout rooms available for your team to practice in. Once you have presented you can join the audience and watch the remaining teams.

- The Top 3 Winning Teams will be announced at the end of the final competition in person on March 20, 2026 followed by a reception.

## PRESENTATION FORMAT

Final round presentations will last for 30 minutes. The time will be broken down as follows:

- 15-minute presentation
- 10-minute Q&A
- 5-minutes rotation

## EVENT DETAILS

**Accommodations – Visiting Teams**
ALT Hotel – University District
Address: 482 Mclaurin St. NW, Calgary, AB.
Phone: 1-833-391-0482 (Toll free)
+1 (403) 648-0482 (Local)

- Visiting teams will be provided two rooms with two queen beds in each room

**Welcome Reception**
***Date:*** March 19, 2026
***Time:*** 5pm – 7pm
***Location:*** Borough Bar and Grill
*This is across the street from the hotel the visiting teams are staying in
***Dress Code:*** Business Casual

**DICC Finals**
***Date:*** March 20, 2026
***Time:*** 8:30am - 2:30pm
***Location:*** Mathison Hall Event Centre MTH 306
***Dress code:*** Business Casual

**Celebration Night Out**
*Calgary teams will host visiting teams in a fun night out exploring the city*
***Date:*** March 20, 2026
***Time:*** After competiton
***Location:*** TBA
***Dress Code:*** Casual

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## TIMELINE

**All times are in MST*

| | ***Thursday, March 19, 2026*** |
|---|---|
| **4:45 PM – 5:00 PM** | Students arrive at Borough Bar and Grill |
| **5:00 PM – 7:00 PM** | Networking and socializing |
| **6:30 PM – 7:00 PM** | Finals presentation order announced |

**All times are in MST*

| | ***Friday, March 20, 2026*** |
|---|---|
| **8:30 AM** | Students and Judges arrive |
| **8:45 – 9:00 AM** | Welcome Remarks |
| **9:00 – 9:30 AM** | Presentation 1 |
| **9:30 – 10:00 AM** | Presentation 2 |
| **10:00 – 10:30 AM** | Presentation 2 |
| **10:30 – 11:00 AM** | Presentation 4 |
| **11:00 – 11:20 AM** | BREAK |
| **11:20 – 11:50 AM** | Presentation 5 |
| **11:50 – 12:20 PM** | Presentation 6 |
| **12:20 – 12:50 PM** | Presentation 7 |
| **12:50 – 1:20 PM** | Judge Deliberations |
| **1:20 – 1:35 PM** | Winner announced |
| **1:35 – 2:35 PM** | Reception |
| **2:35 PM** | Session ends |

## CONTACT INFORMATION

If you have any questions, please email us at entrepreneurship@haskayne.ucalgary.ca